

GETTING TO KNOW YOU - AN INTERMEDIATE INTEGRATED-SKILLS MODULE FOR ENGLISH LEARNERS



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Book: People and Places - An Intermediate
Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners
(Ferguson)

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Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

To the Instructor

Dear instructor,

Thank you for choosing "Getting to Know You" for your ESL class!

This module is designed for an intermediate level ESL class with an academic focus. It may be used alone or in conjunction with the first module in the series, "[People and Places](#)." Both modules use a genre-based approach to reading, writing, speaking and listening. In this module, authentic texts on a single theme and single genre (biographical profiles) allow students to encounter a range of exemplars of one genre and build rhetorical flexibility. The materials present the opportunity to practice reading strategies, analyze rhetorical features, and produce original texts using the authentic texts as models. In "Getting to Know You," students read, watch and analyze biographical profiles about students, interns, employees, artists and volunteers. They watch a TED talk about conducting an interview, then write questions for their own formal interview. The culminating project involves conducting an interview and composing a biographical profile of a classmate or community member.

Grammar and vocabulary instruction are thematically integrated. Vocabulary activities and quizzes are included. Grammar is presented using inductive and deductive reasoning in slide presentations that offer curated videos with grammar instruction for extended study and thematically related practice activities.

I recommend using this module during the first half of a semester, since it offers the opportunity to interview and write about a classmate and build community in the classroom. The module comprises three chapters, or approximately four weeks' materials for a six-unit ESL community college class.

Materials in Google doc and Google slide format are available at [Getting to Know You](#). Instructors can also find password protected quizzes and answer keys at that site. Please don't hesitate to contact me with any comments or questions about this module. I hope you and your students enjoy!

Sara Ferguson

Grossmont College

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Exploring Profiles

Learning Objectives

What is a profile? In this chapter, read and watch several examples of profiles. Practice vocabulary related to school and careers, and learn about past tense verbs and forming questions.

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1.1: Video: Amazon Employee Profile

Analyzing a Profile Video

Watch the employee profile video and answer the questions below. Then discuss with your instructor and classmates.



- Where would you expect to see this video? (**genre**)
 - On Instagram
 - On a dating website
 - On a college website
 - On a company website
- Who is the **audience** for this video? Choose all that apply.
 - The company Amazon
 - The general public
 - John's friends and family
 - A company that needs employees
- What is the **purpose** of this video? Choose all that apply.
 - To help John find a new job
 - To explain step by step how to get hired at Amazon
 - To show how happy an employee is working for Amazon
 - To make the company feel more personal by introducing some of its employees
- What elements of the reading helped you decide the answers to the questions above? Choose all that apply.
 - The topic
 - The format
 - The register (formal or informal language)
 - The pictures
 - The vocabulary
 - Other

This is a video of an employee profile. From watching this video, what are some of the features of a profile? Choose the best answer to each question.

- A profile is:
 - About one person

- About many people
- A profile is:
 - Short
 - Long
- A profile has:
 - A person's whole life history
 - A few facts about the person's history
- A profile focuses on:
 - One part of a person's life, such as work, school, a hobby, or a special interest
 - Everything that is important to that person
- A profile has:
 - A negative tone
 - A positive tone
- A profile is about:
 - Someone famous
 - Anyone

An answer key is attached, but answers may vary.

Contributed by Michele Weaver, Grossmont College

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1.2: Reading: Profile Reynolds

Pre-reading Activity

Discuss or write about the questions below.

- Have you ever visited a national park in the U.S.? Look at the map below for the locations of national parks. Identify Yosemite, Shenandoah, and the Grand Canyon National Parks on the map.
- What is a park ranger? What kind of work does a park ranger do?

File:NationalParks.forwiki.pdf

Figure 1.2.1: The United States' National Parks

Vocabulary Preview

Put a check next to the words you know. Then, ask a classmate or your instructor to explain the words you do not know, or look them up.

- Award
- Recipient
- Develop
- Lead through example
- Inspire
- Mentor
- Challenge
- Journey
- Public service

Profile Reading

Read the profile below. Then answer the questions to check your understanding.

Congratulations to the 2015 **recipient** of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger **Award**!



Figure 1.2.2: Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible **journey** of **public service** and adventures in parks across the country.

Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many

life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.

Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped **develop** the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to **inspire** the new generation of park rangers and **lead through example**.

"I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is **rewarding**, that I am proud of, and one that continues to **challenge** me every day," said Reynolds. "My **inspiration** comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most **rewarding** aspects of my profession is **developing** and **mentoring** others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

After reading the profile, answer the questions below.

- Who is the profile about?
- What organization does she work for?
- Where does she work now?
- What is her job title now?
- Where did she work in the past?
- What job titles did she have in the past?
- What programs and teams did she start or serve?

Answer the questions below with keywords from the article.

- What is the name of the award that Leslie Reynolds received?
- What organization gave her the award?
- The final paragraph of this article has quotation marks. Who is speaking in this paragraph?
- What are at least three professional accomplishments of Leslie Reynolds?
- What inspires Leslie Reynolds, in her own words?

Choose the option that best answers the question.

- What is the purpose of this article?
 - To inform readers of the services at the park
 - To convince readers that Leslie Reynolds is an excellent employee
 - To persuade readers to visit a national park
 - To educate readers about the dangers at the park

Choose all possible answers. Discuss with your classmates and add one reason.

- What are some reasons organizations give awards?
 - To motivate employees to do a good job
 - To inform employees and visitors of the expectations for a good employee
 - To convince customers/visitors that the organization has good employees
 - To make employees feel valuable

Choose the word that best completes the sentence.

- The article mostly has information about Leslie Reynolds' _____ life.
 - Professional
 - Personal

Fill in the blank.

- Leslie Reynolds has worked for the National Park Service for _____ years

Vocabulary Activities**Match the word/phrase with its definition.****Word/Phrase Bank**

- Recipient (n)
- Award (n)
- Develop (v)
- Inspire (v)
- Lead through example (phrase)
- Rewarding (adj)
- Challenge (v)
- Mentor (v)
- Journey (n)
- Public service (noun phrase)

Definitions

- To create or produce especially by deliberate effort over time
- Something suggesting travel from one place to another
- An activity or job paid for by the government and meant to help everyone
- To advise or train someone younger or less experienced
- To act in a way that shows others how to act
- A person or thing that receives something
- A prize in honor of an achievement
- To present a task that requires great effort
- Providing satisfaction
- To make someone feel that they want to do something and can do it

Fill in the blanks below with the vocabulary words from the word/phrase bank above. Use the dictionary if you need it.

- In the 1980's, my family took a long _____ by plane from the U.S. to Mauritius, where I learned about a new culture.
- People who work with computers always _____ new programs to help their customers.
- Learning a new language _____ us in ways we never imagined. It's hard!
- Instead of finding a job at a big corporation, I decided to find a job with the government in _____.
- A good role model like Martin Luther King, Jr or Malala Yousifzai can _____ people to make changes in the world around them.
- She enjoys her job because it's _____. Every day she goes home feeling satisfied.
- The _____ of the Oscar often cry when they give their speeches on stage.
- The Oscar is the highest _____ for movies, and the Tony is the highest _____ (same word) for theater.
- If you want your children to do the right thing, you must _____. That means you have to be a good role model.
- He has a good boss. His boss _____ him and helps him learn how to do his job well.

Words and phrases often occur in the language together. Just like "peanut butter and jelly," some words have collocations, that is, other words that follow or precede them often. The vocabulary words in the word/phrases bank have common collocations, shown below.

- Recipient of
- Award to
- Develop a program/business/system/method
- Inspire (someone) to do (something)

- Rewarding job/task/career/occupation/work/profession
- Challenge (someone) to do (something)
- Mentor (someone)
- Journey to/through/from

Writing activity

Choose five vocabulary words above and write a short paragraph describing a job or career that was or will be rewarding for you.

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1.3: Reading: Student Spotlights

Read the Student Profiles. Then answer the questions to check your understanding.

Student Profile #1

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth, she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.



Figure 1.3.1: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year, her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day, Jennifer!

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Student Profile #2

Student Spotlight--Shivani Mishra

Posted on December 11, 2019 by Christopher Larson

For December's Student Spotlight we present Shivani Mishra! Shivani grew up on Long Island where she attended Half Hollow Hills High School. In 2018 she was inducted into the National Honor Society and the National French Honor Society, and is a three-time winner of the National French Exam Contest. She also happens to be a certified Kenpō Martial Arts black belt... so don't mess with her!

Inspired by her volunteer experience in the hospital and as an emergency medical technician Shivani knew she wanted to learn medicine but when she started her first semester at Stony Brook she had no idea what to major in. Despite the pressure to declare her major she stayed focused on her pre-medicine courses (general chemistry, classical physics, calculus) until she discovered an area of study that she liked

“Physics was especially appealing to me. On Saturdays and Sundays, I enjoyed the quiet and peaceful Math/Physics Library to work on my homework or to peruse the collections. I enjoyed spending my time at the physics library so much that I decided to apply as a student library assistant at the end of the semester.”

– Shivani Mishra



Figure 1.3.2: Shivani Mishra

As a student employee, Shivani learned new skills using the library's vast print and online resources, and building connections with other students and faculty. Eventually, Shivani declared her major in physics. She wants to delve into medicine and physics, and integrate her biomedical research interests with her passion for physics. We wish her the best in all of her academic pursuits. Of course, we're proud to have her on board with us while she does.

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Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

After reading the two profiles above, answer the questions below.

- Who is the author of both profiles?
- What are the titles and dates of publication for each profile?
- What institution published these student spotlights? Make a guess. How did you find the answer to this question?
- Who is the audience for these profiles? Choose all that apply.
 - People who work at Stony Brook University
 - Students who attend Stony Brook University
 - People who want to attend Stony Brook University in the future
 - Students at other universities

Fill out the chart below for both profiles.

	Profile #1	Profile #2
Name of student		
Where she grew up		
High school		
Current major		
Future plans		
Where she works now		

Christopher Larson is the author of both of these profiles. In order to write these profiles, he needed to interview Jennifer Moy and Shivani Mishra. In other words, he needed to ask them questions to find out more about them. Practice composing questions about the readings by completing the activity below.

Read the first paragraph of both profiles again. What questions did the Christopher Larson ask both students? One question has been written below as an example. Write two more questions.

- *Where did you go to high school?*
-
-

Read the second paragraph of Spotlight#1 below. Which question did the interviewer ask Jennifer? Choose the best **open-ended** question. Open-ended questions begin with a "wh" question word and allow for a long answer.

Spotlight #1: *When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth, she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.*

1. Where did you decide to go to college?
2. Where is your new home?
3. Why did you decide to attend Stony Brook University?
4. Did you decide to attend Stony Brook University?

Read the second paragraph of Spotlight#2 below. What question do you think the iChristopher Larson asked Shivani? Write an **open-ended** question.

Spotlight #2: *Inspired by her volunteer experience in the hospital and as an emergency medical technician Shivani knew she wanted to learn medicine but when she started her first semester at Stony Brook she had no idea what to major in. Despite the*

pressure to declare her major she stayed focused on her pre-medicine courses (general chemistry, classical physics, calculus) until she discovered an area of study that she liked.

Most profiles use quotations. Read the excerpt below. It contains a quotation. A quotation is a set of words inside quotation marks. It looks like this: "word word word." Who said the words in the quotation below?

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: *"I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday."*

Note about words used in the U.S. educational system

Students in a four-year program such as high school or university may be identified by the year they are completing in the program.

- First year--**freshman**
- Second year--**sophomore**
- Third year--**junior**
- Fourth year--**senior**

Students earning their associate's or bachelor's degree are called **undergraduate** students.

Students earning a degree after their bachelor's degree are called **graduate** students.

Common degrees offered in U.S. colleges and universities are **associate's** (2-year), **bachelor's** (4-year), **master's** (bachelor's plus 2 years), and **doctorate** (master's plus a varying number of years)

vocabulary: despite

Despite is a contrast signal word that means "even though" or "in spite of."

We use "despite" to say the situation or person was not affected by something.

"Despite" is used before a noun phrase.

Example: Despite my head cold, I went to work today (I went to work even though I had a head cold).

Example: Despite the difficulty of the final exam, the students passed the class (the students passed the class even though the final exam was difficult).

vocabulary words and phrases related to college/university

- Dormitory
- Freshman
- Sophomore
- Junior
- Senior
- Major
- Declare a major
- Graduate (n) (v)
- Graduation
- Associate's, bachelor's, master's degree
- Specialize
- Semester
- Program

vocabulary words and phrases for careers and education

- Inspire
- Motivate
- On board
- Volunteer (n) (v)
- Intern
- Pursue (v)
- Pursuit (n)
- Adventure
- In (high, low) demand
- Resource
- Travel

idioms and signal words

- By a long shot
- Don't mess with
- Despite

majors and specializations

- Photography
- Geography
- Architecture
- Physics

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1.4: Reading: Profile Gibson

Pre-reading Activity

Before you read, discuss the questions below with your classmates.

- What are some majors that students can pursue in college or university?
- Which of these majors are good for people who enjoy adventure?

Skim the student profile and fill out the chart below.

Name of student	Major	Name of profile author	Name of university

Vocabulary Preview

Match the words below with their meanings. Then add -er or -or to create a new word that means "a person who _____"

Word Bank

- Geography
- Photography
- Adventure
- Survey
- Travel
- Hydrography

Definitions

- The science of mapping bodies of water, such as seas, lakes, and rivers
- The study of the physical features of the earth as well as populations, resources, land use, and industries
- To make a journey; to go from one place to another
- The art of taking and processing photographs
- To examine and record an area in order to make a map
- An unusual and exciting activity or experience
- A _____ is a person who studies the science of mapping bodies of water, such as seas, lakes, and rivers.
- A _____ is a person who studies the physical features of the earth as well as populations, resources, land use, and industries.
- A _____ is a person who makes a journey or goes from one place to another.
- A _____ is a person who practices the art of taking and processing photographs.
- A _____ is a person who examines and records an area in order to make a map.
- An _____ is a person who has an unusual and exciting activity or experience.

Student Profile

Student Spotlight--Cody Gibson

June 25, 2014

Geomatics major, Class of 2015

Hometown: Shawnee, Oklahoma



image courtesy Cody Gibson

Did you know that while 24 people have been to the moon, just three have been to the deepest part of the ocean? We have more understanding of the moon's geography than the geography of Earth's sea floor.

"The ocean is only five to eight percent mapped," said Cody Gibson, a geomatics student at the University of Alaska, Anchorage and adventurer who is committed to mapping the mysterious depths of the ocean. The challenge? Average depths of about 14,000 feet--that's 2.65 miles. Cody works for Fugro Pelagos, a company with surveyors around the world who specialize in mapping the sea floor.

Before we learn more of Cody's story, an important question: what does a person studying geomatics do? Besides wear orange vests around campus, of course.

"Essentially we're mapping the Earth, using math, physics, law practices, everything possible," he said.

With just one semester left until his December graduation, Cody is looking forward to committing full-time to Fugro, the company he first connected with as an intern almost two years ago. Geomatics graduates are in such high demand in Alaska, he said, it's rare for a student to graduate without a job offer in hand.

"If they don't have an offer by graduation," he said, "they'll have one in a matter of weeks." Most will end up working in land surveying, but Cody is excited to be working in his specialized field, hydrography, which keeps him out on the water through much of the summer, surveying and outfitting boats with state-of-the-art mapping equipment.

"University of Alaska, Anchorage is my 17th school since I was in first grade," Cody said with a grin. "My mom just liked to travel a lot so we traveled often. She'd start at a new school, I'd start at a new school. She's a teacher--English, drama, music, all sorts of things."



Image courtesy Cody Gibson

UAA is Cody's third college. After graduating from high school in Oregon, he studied photography at Southern Oregon University. After Oregon, he transferred to University of Colorado, Colorado Springs. There he took all their photography courses and started thinking about alternatives. He caught sight of a roadside survey crew and it got him thinking.

He began researching geomatics programs and decided to go to UAA. Alaska sounded like the best adventure, so he headed North.

"I love it. I've spent less than a month out of the state since I moved here," he said.

When he's not working or in class, he's exploring Alaska. He enjoys solo kayaking adventures, hiking, and biking. He keeps a camera close by on his adventures, too. His first summer in Alaska he spent working for an aerial mapping company.



Cody in his kayak. Image courtesy Cody Gibson

If all goes to plan, Cody's next adventures may take him back up in the air to get a better look at the oceans below.

"There's an overlay between hydrography and LIDAR, which is where they shoot lasers down from a plane to map the earth by millions and millions of data points," he explained. "There's a crossover there called LIDAR bathymetry and that's really what I'm interested in--mapping the ocean with LIDAR."

That's something Fugro does, he said. Geomatics gives him the opportunity to travel around the world. His degree will take him everywhere from Belize to Trinidad to Saudi Arabia for winter work.

Alaska, too, will remain on his list for personal and professional exploration.

"I've only been to a small percentage of Alaska and there's so much left to do," he said. "I came up to Alaska for an adventure and exceeded my expectations by a long shot."

This story written by Jamie Gonzales, UAA Office of University Advancement

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Comprehension Questions

Read the profile a second time and answer the questions below.

- What company does Cody work for and what do they do?
- Which of the following defines "mapping"?
 - Putting locations on a map
 - Sleeping peacefully in the afternoon
 - Wearing an orange vest around campus
- When will Cody graduate? Where will he work after he graduates?
- What subject did Cody study before he came to the University of Alaska?
- What are some advantages of studying geomatics, according to the profile? Choose all that apply.
 - Jobs in geomatics are easy to find
 - Geomatics is an easy major
 - The professors are very nice and helpful
 - The jobs in geomatics offer interesting travel
 - Geomatics technology is interesting
 - People who work in geomatics are active

Writing Interview Questions

When an author writes a profile, they need to conduct an interview first in order to gather information about their subject. The author of this profile is Jamie Gonzalez. Jamie Gonzalez asked Cody about his life, his studies and his future career. What questions do you think Jamie Gonzalez asked?

For each answer, write the questions that the interviewer probably asked Cody. There is more than one possible question for each answer, but try to start your question with the word provided. The first task is completed for you as an example.

- I work for Fugro Pelagos, a company with surveyors around the world who specialize in mapping the seafloor.
 - Question: Where do you work?
- Essentially, we're mapping the Earth, using math, physics, law practices, everything possible.
 - Question: What....
- I first connected with Fugro Pelagos as an intern two years ago.
 - Question: How...
- University of Alaska, Anchorage is my 17th school since I was in first grade.
 - Question: Where...
- My mom just liked to travel a lot so we traveled often.
 - Question: Why...
- I started at Southern Oregon University; then I attended University of Colorado.
 - Question: Where...
- Alaska sounded like the best adventure
 - Question: Why...
- I enjoy solo kayaking adventures, hiking, and biking. I always take my camera.

- Question: Why...
- Read the last section of the profile, starting at "If all goes to plan..." What question did the interviewer ask to learn all of this information? Write an **open-ended** question.

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1.5: Reading: Profile Valdez

Pre-reading Activity

Write about or discuss the questions below.

- What do you know about NASA? What do NASA employees do?
- Skim the photos and captions in the reading below for 30 seconds. Who is the article about?
- What can you say about him?

Guided Reading Activity

When you are faced with a particularly challenging reading assignment, sometimes it helps to pause to ask and answer questions after each section or paragraph. In this activity, practice using questioning as a strategy to understand difficult text. Pause and answer the questions after each paragraph.

Felipe Valdez: Life at a Crossroads

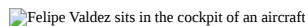


Figure 1.5.1: NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center is home to many NASA airplanes. Here, Felipe Valdez sits inside the cockpit of a large aircraft

Many students move away from home when they start college. While some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. In 2007, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico and move to the United States to pursue his education and career. At the time, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school, and find a full-time job, or he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

- Where is Felipe Valdez from?
- Why did he decide to move?

After moving to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, about an hour outside Sacramento. Despite the challenge of integrating into a new culture and learning a new language, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

- Where did Felipe go to high school?
- Was he successful? Identify the clause that gives you the answer to this question

After high school, Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. He first attended Yuba Community College where, in addition to earning his associate degree and graduating with honors, he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He then went on to study at California State University, Sacramento, where he became heavily involved on campus and received several scholarships. During his time at Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. He also became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

- Where did Felipe start college?
- Where did Felipe finish college?
- What awards has Felipe won? What subjects is he good at?

After completing his undergraduate degree with honors, Felipe enrolled as a mechanical engineering graduate student at California State University, Sacramento. Here he has had the opportunity to work alongside one of his professors and NASA fellow Dr. Jose Granda on NASA research projects. Granda uses Space Grant funding to fuel NASA student research at the university.

- Where is Felipe studying now?
- Who is mentoring him?

His project with Granda involved designing a control system for the NASA Morpheus space vehicle, a prototype planetary vehicle capable of vertical takeoff and landing. His first goal was to design a control system that allows for the adjustment of the thrust force while maintaining the vehicle's orientation and position only in the vertical direction.

- What is the name of the space vehicle Felipe is working on?

- This paragraph is challenging. Identify the words that you understand and discuss with your classmates. Can you get a general idea about his project?

While completing his internship at NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center the following semester, Felipe and two other Sacramento State students worked on the next goal, which is the design of a more advanced control system on Morpheus, the very same vehicle he had worked on during his undergraduate research. He aimed to create a system that would allow the vehicle to perform complex maneuvers autonomously.

 Felipe Valdez poses in front of NASA's Space Exploration Vehicle

Figure 1.5.2: Felipe Valdez explored the Mars rock yard at NASA's Armstrong Flight Research Center. Here he poses in front of the Space Exploration Vehicle

- The photo shows a picture of the space vehicle Felipe is working on. What is he trying to improve on the vehicle?

"Felipe is the type of intern most mentors desire," said his NASA mentor, Oscar Murillo. "He is eager to engage in the research, asking questions to figure out the next step, and willing to learn new skills to accomplish the tasks."

Because of his guidance toward a NASA internship, Felipe would like to thank Dr. Granda for inspiring him to pursue an education in STEM. "He motivated, pushed, and helped me," says Felipe. "Thanks to him, I got interested in aerospace engineering and the pursuit of higher education."

- The final two paragraphs have quotation marks. Who is speaking in each paragraph?

Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

Answer the questions below.

- This profile is most likely found:
 - In a national newspaper
 - On the NASA website about interns
 - On the National Parks website about volunteers
 - On the Facebook dating website
- The purpose of this profile is:
 - To convince the reader to donate money to NASA
 - To convince the reader that their taxes are well spent at NASA
 - To inform the reader about different programs at NASA
 - To inform the reader about different colleges in California
- Discuss with your classmates. What other purposes could this profile fulfill?
- What information is not included in this profile?
 - Felipe's educational accomplishments
 - Felipe's immigration history
 - Felipe's projects at NASA
 - Quotes that praise Felipe and his mentor
 - Information about Felipe's family

Identifying Past Tense Verbs

Read the following passage again. Identify all of the verbs. Most verbs are in the simple past tense. Why? A few are not in the simple past tense. Why not? Discuss with your instructor and classmates.

Passage One

Many students move away from home when they start college. While some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. In 2007, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico and move to the United States to pursue his education and career. At the time, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school, and find a full-time job, or he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

After moving to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, about an hour outside Sacramento. Despite the challenge of integrating into a new culture and learning a new language, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

After high school, Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. He first attended Yuba Community College where, in addition to earning his associate degree and graduating with honors, he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He then went on to study at California State University, Sacramento, where he became heavily involved on campus and received several scholarships. During his time at Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. He also became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

Identifying Signals for Cohesion and Coherence

Examine Passage One again. This passage has many words, phrases, and clauses that help with the cohesion and coherence of the passage. Identify the words and phrases that help you understand **when** each event happened.

Cohesion and coherence are the connection of ideas at the sentence and text level. Below is the passage without signals to help with cohesion and coherence.

Passage Two

Many students move away from home when they start college. Some move to a new city or state. NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico. He moved to the United States. Felipe pursued his education and career. Felipe's life was at a crossroads. Felipe could stay in Mexico. Felipe could leave school. Felipe could find a full-time job. Felipe could move to the U.S. Felipe could have the opportunity to continue his education.

Felipe moved to California. Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City. Yuba City is an hour outside Sacramento. Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. Felipe attended Yuba Community College. Felipe received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. Felipe studied at California State University, Sacramento. Felipe became heavily involved on campus. Felipe received several scholarships. At Sacramento State, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. Felipe became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

Practice with Signal Words for Cohesion and Coherence

With your instructor, discuss the difference in tone, style, and meaning between Passage One and Passage Two. Which passage is easier to understand? Which passage is more interesting to read? Which passage has more repetition? What's missing from the second passage?

Now fill in the missing words in Passage Two, using the information from Passage One.

Passage Two--Revised

Many students move away from home when they start college. _____ some move to a new city or state, NASA intern Felipe Valdez moved to a new country. _____, Felipe made the difficult decision to leave his home in Mexico _____ move to the United States to pursue his education and career. _____, his life was at a crossroads. He could stay in Mexico, leave school and find a full-time job, _____ he could move to the U.S. and have the opportunity to continue his education.

_____ to California, Felipe started his sophomore year at River Valley High School in Yuba City, _____ hour outside Sacramento. _____, Felipe excelled in all his courses and graduated with an excellent GPA.

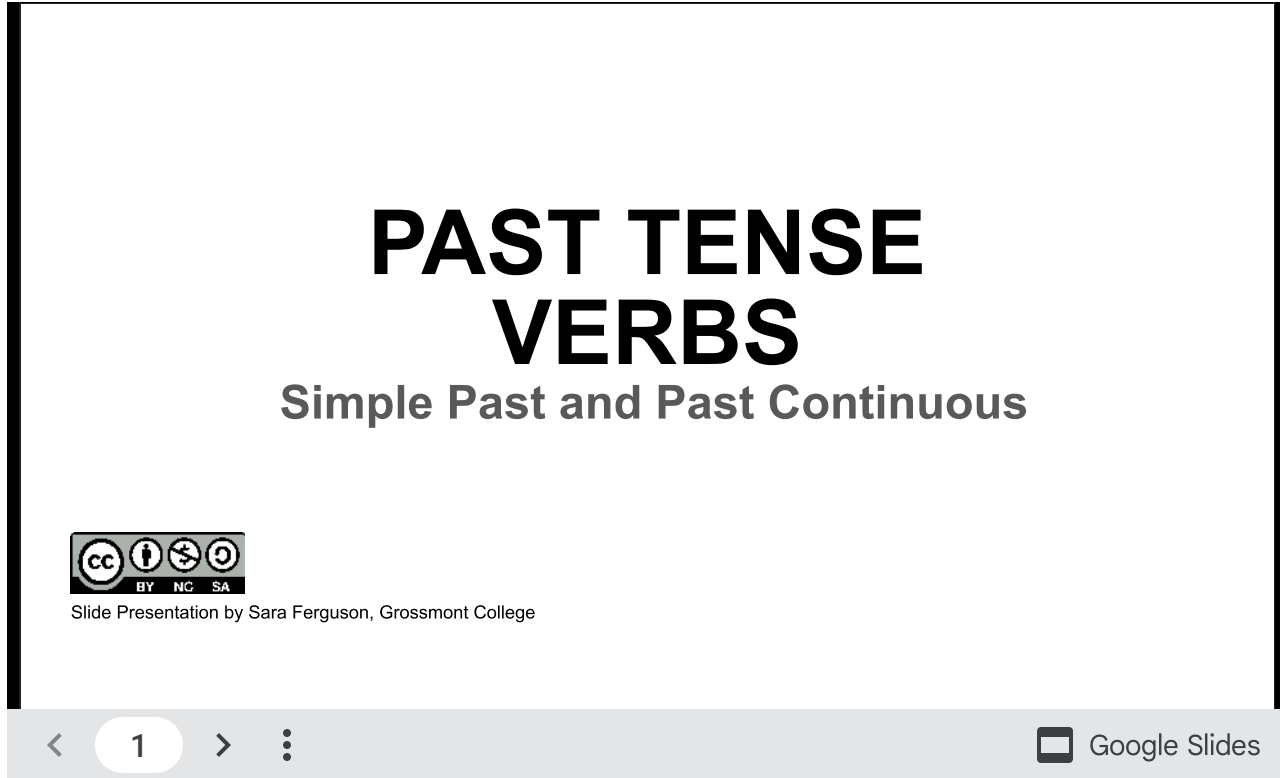
_____, Felipe began to work on his bachelor's degree. He _____ first attended Yuba Community College _____ he received the Extended Opportunity Programs & Services Student Role Model and the Mathematics, Engineering, and Science Achievement Student of the Year awards. He _____ went on to study at California State University, Sacramento, _____ became heavily

involved on campus and received several scholarships. _____, Felipe was invited to join the Engineering Honor Society, Tau Beta Pi. He _____ became a member of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, the MESA Engineering Program, and the Leader Initiative Program.

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1.6: Grammar: Past Tense Verbs

This lesson is available as a [slide](#) presentation.



Simple Past and Past Continuous

Compare these sentences. What are the verbs? How is the past tense formed in each sentence?

- Cody Gibson studied photography in Oregon and Colorado.
- Cody was studying photography when he decided to change his major.

Answers

- In the first sentence, the verb is "studied," simple past regular verb.
- In the second sentence, the verbs are "was studying" (past continuous) and "decided" (simple past)

Simple Past Form

Regular verbs use base verb + -ed

- EX: Decide--decided

Irregular verbs do not follow one rule

- EX: Find--found
- EX: Eat--eaten

Past Tense Spelling for Regular Verbs (Adding -ed)

- Most regular verbs add -ed to the infinitive form
 - EX: Walk--walked
- Regular verbs ending in -e just add -d
 - EX: Like--liked

- EX: Receive--received
- CVC Rule: Regular verbs ending in one stressed vowel + one consonant (except w, x, or y) double the consonant and add -ed
 - EX: Plan--planned
 - EX: Stop--stopped
 - EX: Refer--referred
 - EX: Control--controlled
- Regular verbs ending in consonant + y change the y to i and add -ed
 - EX: Carry--carried
 - EX: Study--studied
 - EX: Try--tried
- Regular verbs ending in -c add -ked
 - EX: Picnic--picnicked
 - EX: Traffic--trafficked
- Default: All other regular verbs add -ed
 - Ending in one or more vowels (except final e)
 - EX: Moo--mooed
 - EX: Ski--skied
 - Ending in two or more consonants
 - EX: Depend--depended
 - EX: Push--pushed
 - EX: Start--started
 - Ending in unstressed syllable and one consonant
 - EX: Market--marketed
 - EX: Number--numbered
 - EX: Question--questioned
 - Ending in two or more vowels + one consonant
 - EX: Explain--explained
 - EX: Rain--rained
 - Ending in vowel + y
 - EX: Enjoy--enjoyed
 - EX: Play--played
 - Ending in w or x
 - EX: Show--showed
 - EX: Tax--taxed

Ninety Common Irregular Verbs

Be--was/were--been

Beat--beat--beaten

Become--became--become

Begin--began--begun

Blow--blew--blown

Break--broke--broken

Bring--brought--brought

Build--built--built

Burst--burst--burst
Buy--bought--bought
Catch--caught--caught
Choose--chose--chosen
Come--came--come
Cost--cost--cost
Cut--cut--cut
Deal--dealt--dealt
Do--did--done
Drink--drank--drunk
Drive--drove--driven
Eat--ate--eaten
Forgive--forgave--forgiven
Freeze--froze--frozen
Get--got--got/gotten
Give--gave--given
Go--went--gone
Grow--grew--grown
Have--had--had
Fall--fell--fallen
Feed--fed--fed
Feel--felt--felt
Fight--fought--fought
Find--found--found
Fly--flew--flown
Forbid--forbade--forbidden
Forget--forgot--forgotten
Hear--heard--heard
Hide--hid--hidden
Hit--hit--hit
Hold--held--held
Hurt--hurt--hurt
Keep--kept--kept
Know--knew--known
Lay--laid--laid
Lead--led--led
Leave--left--left

Let--let--let

Lie--lay--lain (be in horizontal position) ("lie" is regular when it means not to tell the truth)

Lose--lost--lost

Make--made--made

Meet--met--met

Pay--paid--paid

Put--put--put

Quit--quit--quit

Read--read--read

Ride--rode--ridden

Ring--rang--rung

Rise--rose--risen

Run--ran--run

Say--said--said

See--saw--seen

Seek--sought--sought

Sell--sold--sold

Send--sent--sent

Shake--shook--shaken

Shine--shone--shone

Sing--sang--sung

Sit--sat--sat

Sleep--slept--slept

Speak--spoke--spoken

Spend--spent--spent

Spring--sprang--sprung

Stand--stood--stood

Steal--stole--stolen

Swim--swam--swum

Swing--swung--swung

Take--took--taken

Teach--taught--taught

Tear--tore--torn

Tell--told--told

Think--thought--thought

Throw--threw--thrown

Understand--understood--understood

Wake--woke--woken

Wear--wore--worn

Win--won--won

Write--wrote--written

More Irregular Verbs

A complete list of irregular verbs may be found [here](#).

Suggested lists for learning irregular verbs may be found [here](#).

Irregular verb flashcards for practice may be found [here](#).

Using Simple Past

Simple past is used for any completed action(s) in the past. The action may be in the recent or distant past. It may be a single or repeated action.

- When he was a child, Cody attended 17 different schools.
- Last week, he got a job with his dream company.

Which sentence talks about an action in the recent past? Which sentence talks about an action in the distant past? Which sentence talks about a repeated action? Which sentence talks about a single action?

Answers

- The second sentence talks about an action in the recent past.
- The first sentence talks about an action in the distant past.
- The first sentence talks about a repeated action.
- The second sentence talks about a single action.

Past Continuous Form

Two ways to describe the form:

- "Be" (past tense) + base verb + -ing
- "Was/were" + present participle

EX: While we were writing a thank you letter, she was sleeping.

Spelling Rules for Adding -ing to a Verb

No change	Most verbs: Add -ing	Read--reading Talk--talking Say--saying Want--wanting
No change	Verbs that end in -y: Add -ing	Study--studying Carry--carrying Play--playing
Change	Verbs that end in -e: Drop the -e and add -ing	Wake--waking Make--making Tape--taping
Change	Verbs that end in -ie: Change the -ie to -y	Die--dying Lie--lying
Change	Verbs that end in CVC (consonant, vowel, consonant), one syllable: Double the last letter	Stop--stopping Sit--sitting Ban--banning
Change	Verbs that end in CVC, two syllables: If the stress is on the last syllable, double the last letter	Begin--beginning Refer--referring BUT Listen--listening Cancel--canceling

Using Past Continuous

There are two common uses for past continuous form.

Use 1: An action in progress is interrupted by another event or time

- EX: When you arrived, we were writing you a letter
- EX: At 10:00 AM, she was walking around her neighborhood

In the first sentence, which action takes longer? Which action interrupts? In the second sentence, what action was she doing when the clock said 10:00 AM?

Answers

In the first sentence, it takes longer to write. Your arrival interrupted the writing. The interruption is in simple present, the longer action is in past continuous. In the second sentence, she was walking (past continuous) when the clock changed to 10:00 AM (simple past).

Use 2: Two actions in progress at the same time.

- EX: We were reading while the instructor was writing on the board.
- EX: While she was walking around the neighborhood, she was getting fresh air and exercise.

In the first sentence, which action took longer, reading or writing? In the second sentence, which action took longer, walking or getting?

Answers

In the first sentence, reading and writing happened at the same time. We don't know which one took longer. In the second sentence, walking and getting fresh air happened at the same time. They both started and ended at the same time.

Videos

Watch [this video](#) to learn about the simple past tense.

Watch [this video](#) to learn about the difference between simple and continuous past.

Watch [this video](#) and [this video](#) to learn more about the past continuous form.

Practice the Past Tenses

An achievement is the act of reaching a goal. Examples of achievements include:

- Completing a difficult class
- Earning a degree
- Getting a job
- Finding an apartment
- Saving enough money to buy a house or car
- Raising a healthy family
- Learning to cook a special dish

Think of two more examples with your classmates.

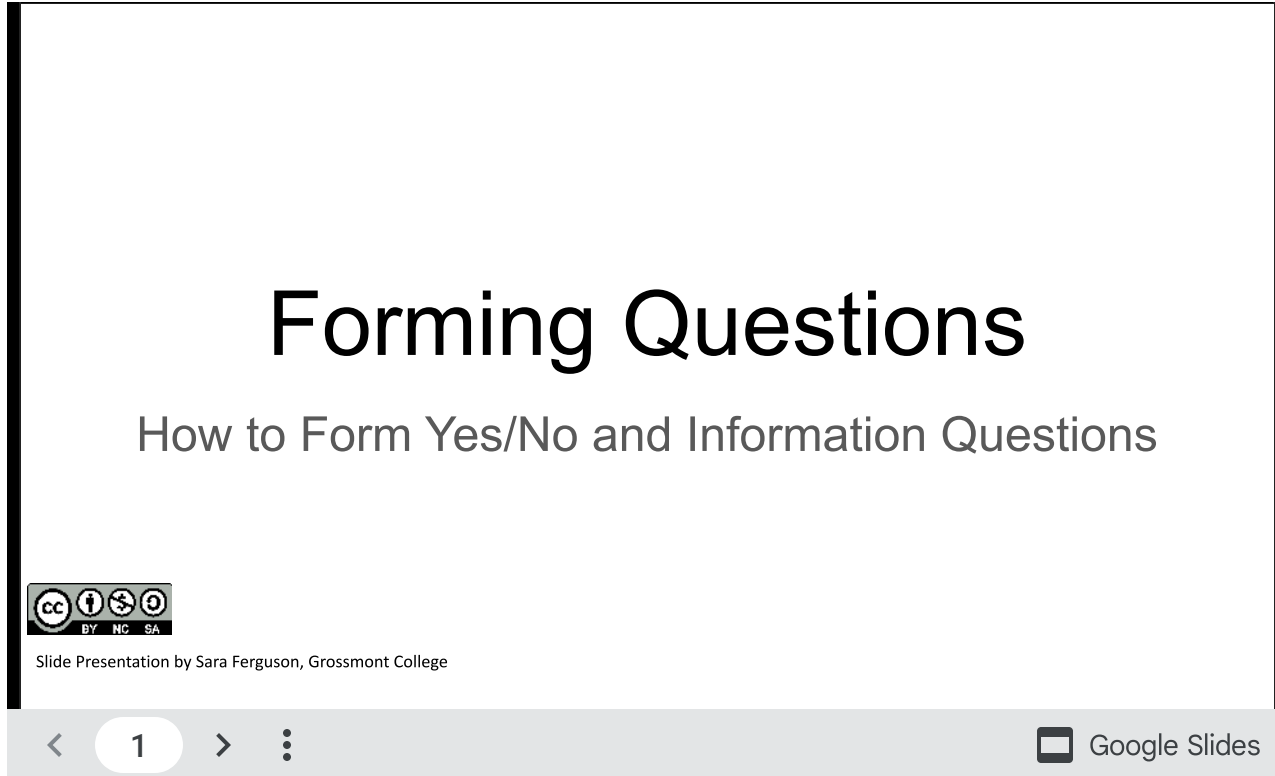
When we achieve a goal, we feel proud. Write a list of three achievements that make you feel proud.

Choose one achievement and write a paragraph about it. Describe all the steps you took to achieve your goal. What was difficult about achieving your goal?

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1.7: Grammar: Forming Questions

This lesson is available as a [slide](#) presentation.



Forming Yes/No Questions with a Main Verb

Compare these sentences...

- In 2007, Felipe Valdez moved to the United States to pursue his education
- Since 2007, he has completed his bachelor's degree
- He is pursuing his career as an intern at NASA

What are the verbs? What is the tense of each verb? What is the aspect of each verb? What are the auxiliaries for each verb? Remember, tense = past, present, future, aspect = simple, continuous, perfect, and auxiliary = be, have, do...

Answers

- In the first sentence, the verb is "moved," the aspect is simple, the tense is past, and there is no auxiliary
- In the second sentence, the verb is "had completed," the tense is present, the aspect is perfect, and the auxiliary is "have"
- In the third sentence, the verb is "is pursuing," the tense is present, the aspect is continuous, and the auxiliary is "be"

Compare these questions. Identify the auxiliary, main verb, and subject...

- Did Felipe Valdez move to the U.S.?
- Has he completed his bachelor's degree?
- Is he pursuing his career?

What order do the auxiliary, main verb, and subject follow? What form does each take? What is the rule for forming yes/no questions with a main verb?

Answers

- In the first sentence, the auxiliary is "did," the main verb is "move," and the subject is "Felipe Valdez;" "move" is the base form, used with simple aspect

- In the second sentence, the auxiliary is "has," the main verb is "completed," and the subject is "he;" "completed" is the past participle, used with perfect present
- In the third sentence, the auxiliary is "is," the main verb is "pursuing," and the subject is "he;" "pursuing" is the present participle, used with continuous aspect

The auxiliary, subject, and main verb follow this order: aux + subject + verb with aspect

They take the following forms: aux has the tense and main verb has the aspect

The rule for forming yes/no questions with a main verb is as follows: aux + subject + verb with aspect + complement

Forming Yes/No Questions with "Be"

Compare these sentences...

- Felipe Valdez attended University of California, Sacramento
- He was an excellent student
- He was studying mechanical engineering

What is the verb in each sentence?

Answers

- The verb is "attended"
- The verb is "was"
- The verb is "was studying"

Compare these questions...

- Did he attend UC Sacramento?
- Is he an excellent student?
- Was he studying mechanical engineering?

What is the auxiliary verb in each? What is the main verb in each?

Answers

- The auxiliary is "did," the main verb is "attend"
- The main verb is "are" (be)
- The auxiliary is "be," the main verb is "studying"

Rule: When the main verb is "be," use "be" in the same position as the auxiliary; aux + subject + complement. When the main verb is not "be," use an auxiliary to create a question. Auxiliary verbs are "do," "be," and "have"...

Forming Information Questions with a Main Verb

Compare these questions. How are they different?

- Did Felipe Valdez move to the U.S.?
- When did Felipe Valdez move to the U.S.?
- Was he studying mechanical engineering?
- Where was he studying mechanical engineering?

Which questions ask for the answer "yes" or "no?" Which questions ask for more information? Do the auxiliary, subject, and verb follow the same order in information questions as they do in yes/no questions?

Answers

The first sentence in each pair asks for the answer "yes" or "no." The second question in each pair asks for more information. Yes, the auxiliary, subject, and verb follow the same order in information questions as they do in yes/no questions

What is the Pattern for Information Questions?

Wh + aux + subject + verb with aspect + complement. This pattern works for all tenses

Check the pattern above on the questions below...

- When was he studying mechanical engineering?
- Where did he complete his bachelor's degree?
- How did he design the space vehicle controls?
- Why has he become an intern at NASA?

Questions About the Subject

Questions about the subject follow a different pattern

- Scientists have studied space for many years

Compare the two questions. What is the answer to each question?

- Who has studied space for many years?
- What have scientists studied for many years?

What is the question order in the first question? What is the question order in the second question?

Answers

- The answer to the first question is "scientists"
- The answer to the second question is "space"

The question order in the first question is "who/what" + verb (with tense/aspect in third singular) + complement

The question order in the second sentence is wh + auxiliary + subject + verb (with aspect)

Here is another example...

- The scientists warned the mayor about the meteor

Compare these two questions. What is the answer to each question?

- Who warned the mayor about the meteor?
- Who did the scientists warn about the meteor?

Which question is asking about the subject? What is the question word order in each question?

Answers

- The answer to the first question is "scientists"
- The answer to the second question is "the mayor"

The first question is asking about the subject. The word order in the first question is "who/what" + verb (with tense/aspect in third singular) + complement and the word order in the second question is wh + auxiliary + subject + verb (with aspect)

Questions with a Noun Phrase in the Question Word

Some questions have the subject or object in the question word. These include "how many _____," "how much _____," "what kind of _____," and "which _____"

Compare these sentences...

- How many students are attending UC Sacramento?
- How many awards has Felipe won?

Which question has a question word as the subject? Which question has a question word as an object? Does the verb always agree with the subject?

Answers

The first question has a question word as the subject. The second question has a question word as an object. Yes, the verb always agrees with the subject

Key Takeaways

- Auxiliary words are "do," "be," "have," and modals
- Question words are "who," "what," "when," "where," "why," and "how"
- Tenses are past, present, and future
- Verb with aspects means:
 - Continuous: verb + -ing (present participle)
 - Simple: base form
 - Perfect: past participle
- Yes/no questions will use the order: aux + subject + verb with aspect
- Information questions will use the order wh + auxiliary + subject + verb with aspect
- Questions about the subject are the exception. They use:
 - "Who/what" + verb with tense and aspect + complement

Videos and Other Resources

Watch [this video](#) and [this video](#) for more information about forming questions in English...

Still not sure about subject questions? Try [this video and written explanation](#)...

Practice Question Formation

Write questions about the profile below...

Leslie Reynolds began as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park. Then she went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents. Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped develop the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen. As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to inspire the new generation of park rangers and lead through example.

- Leslie Reynolds began her career at Yosemite National Park
 - Where...
- Leslie Reynolds worked as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and counselor
 - How many jobs...
- Leslie has helped save hikers, climbers, and accident victims
 - Who...
- Because she understands the importance of prevention and education, Leslie developed the PSAR programs
 - Why...
- Leslie has worked for the National Park Service for 21 years
 - How long...

Answers

- Where did Leslie Reynolds begin her career?
- How many jobs did Leslie Reynolds do?
- Who has Leslie helped save?

- Why did Leslie develop the PSAR programs?
 - How long has Leslie worked for the National Park Service?
-

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Conducting an Interview

Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, students will be able to

1. Interview a peer using open-ended questions and effective listening skills.
2. Compose grammatically accurate questions.
3. Use vocabulary related to career and education.

2.1: Watch: Celeste Headlee TED Talk

2.2: Watch: Brandon Stanton Video Mashup

2.3: Question Practice: Profile Diana Nyad

2.4: Question Practice: Profile Stanton

2.5: Vocabulary Review: Getting to Know You

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2.1: Watch: Celeste Headlee TED Talk

Watching a TED Talk

Celeste Headlee "10 Ways to Have a Better Conversation"

Celeste Headlee is an experienced radio host who interviews people for a living. Watch [the video](#) and then answer the questions below.



- What skill does Celeste Headlee think we need to learn?
- What problems make conversation difficult these days?
- As you hear them in the TED talk, put a check next to the rules for better conversation. Take notes. Be prepared to explain the rules to your classmates.
 - Don't multitask
 - Don't pontificate
 - Ask open-ended questions
 - Go with the flow
 - If you don't know, say you don't know
 - Don't equate your experiences with others
 - Don't repeat yourself
 - Stay out of the weeds
 - Listen
 - Be brief
- According to Celeste Headlee, which rule is the most important?
- In your opinion, which rule is the most important? Do you disagree with any rule? Can you add a rule?
- What does Celeste Headlee mean when she says "Be prepared to be amazed"?
- Remember the video. Which features did the TED talk have? Identify all that apply.
 - Quotes
 - Jokes

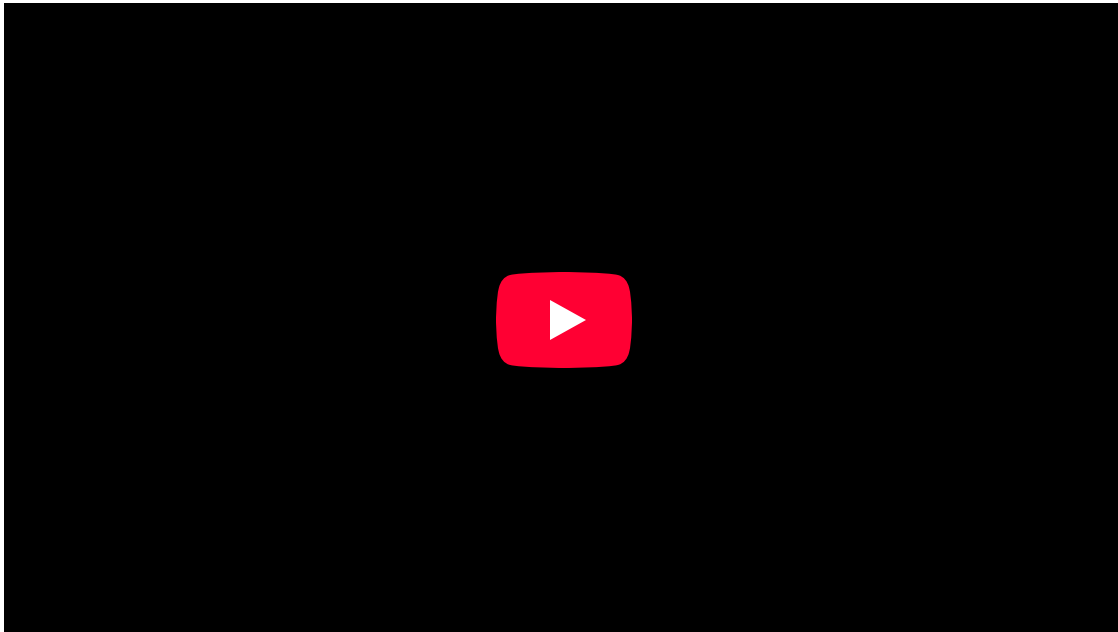
- Visuals
- Examples
- A list
- When you have a conversation, what is the best habit you have to make it a good conversation?

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2.2: Watch: Brandon Stanton Video Mashup

Watch Brandon Stanton in Action

Brandon Stanton is a photographer in New York who interviews and writes stories about the strangers he photographs. He has a famous website, Facebook page, and book called Humans of New York (HONY). Watch [his video](#) and consider the questions below.



- What kind of questions does Brandon ask when he interviews a stranger?
- What do you notice about his attitude toward the people he interviews?

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2.3: Question Practice: Profile Diana Nyad

Diana Nyad

Read the profile of Diana Nyad. Then practice composing questions about the profile.

Pre-reading Questions

Have you ever swum in the ocean? What are some dangers of swimming in the ocean? What is the farthest a human can swim?

Alternative Pre-reading Activity

Diana Nyad's TED talk is available at [this link](#)

Diana Nyad Profile

Diana Nyad is the first person to swim from Havana, Cuba to Florida without a shark cage. She swam 110 miles (180 kilometers) and fifty-three hours. She was 64 years old when she accomplished her goal.



How did she do it?

Nyad attempted the swim five times from 2010 to 2013, and did not succeed until her fifth try in 2013. Each time she tried, she had to stop because of storms, jellyfish stings, asthma and shoulder pain. On Sept 2, 2013, she reached her goal despite these setbacks.

She trained by swimming eight to fourteen hours in the ocean every other week. While she was training, she gathered a team of about 35 people. These people helped her while she was swimming. One person paddled beside her in a kayak and used a device to keep sharks away from her. Others helped her put on a suit to keep jellyfish from stinging her. In order to help her swim in a straight line, her team dragged a streamer during the day and LED lights at night behind a boat and she followed them. To keep her mind busy while she was swimming, she thought about books and movies, counted and sang.

When asked about her motivation, she answered, "Because I'd like to prove to the other 60 year-olds that it is never too late to start your dreams."



Question Practice

Use the wh-questions words who, what, when, why, where, how far, how old, how many times to fill in the blanks.

Diana Nyad is the first person to swim from Cuba to Florida without a shark cage.

_____ is the first person to swim from Cuba to Florida without a shark cage?

She swam 110 miles.

_____ did she swim?

She was 64 years old.

_____ was she?

Nyad attempted the swim five times.

_____ did she attempt the swim?

On September 2, 2013, she reached her goal.

_____ did she reach her goal?

Each time she tried, she had to stop because of storms, jellyfish stings, asthma, and shoulder pain.

_____ did she have to stop?

She trained by swimming eight to fourteen hours in the ocean every other week.

_____ did she train?

In order to help her swim in a straight line, her team dragged streamers behind the boat.

_____ did her team drag streamers behind the boat.

To keep her mind busy, she thought about books and movies, counted and sang.

_____ did she keep her mind busy?

She gathered a team of 35 people.

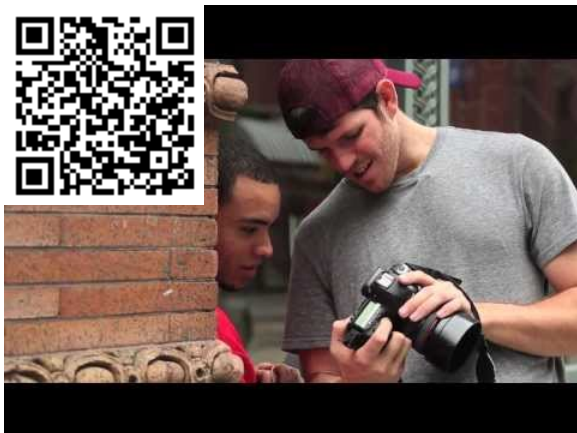
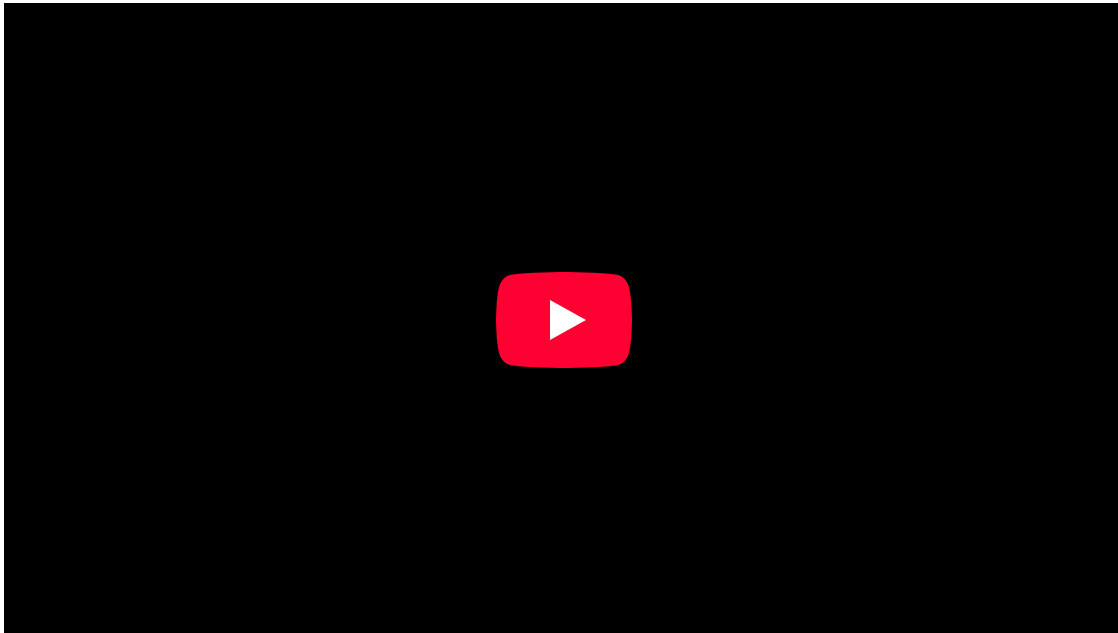
_____ people were on her team?

2.3: Question Practice: Profile Diana Nyad is shared under a [not declared](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by LibreTexts.

2.4: Question Practice: Profile Stanton

Watching a Video Profile

Brandon Stanton



Video Preview

Watch the video profile about Brandon Stanton. After you watch the video one time, write a few keywords or sentences in your notes. What surprised or interested you about the video? Discuss with your classmates.

Watch Again

Watch the video a second time. This time, imagine that you are the journalist writing a profile of Brandon Stanton. What questions should you ask him to find out more information about his passions? Interviewers should always ask **open-ended** questions. Open-ended questions begin with a "wh" question word and allow for a long answer. Stop the video at the suggested points below and take a few minutes to write down an **open-ended** question for Brandon. The first question has been written for you as an example.

Open-ended question words are **what, when, where, why, who, how**. Try to start your question with one of these words.

Example: What do you love about your job?

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2.5: Vocabulary Review: Getting to Know You

Vocabulary Words for "Getting to Know You"

College/University	Careers and Education	Majors and Specializations	Idioms, Affixes, and Signal Words	About the texts
Dormitory	Inspire			
Freshman	Motivate			
Sophomore	Volunteer (n) (v)			
Junior	Intern (n) (v)			
Senior	Pursue (v)			
Major	Pursuit (n)			
Declare a major	Adventure			Purpose
Graduate (v)	In (high, low) demand			Audience
Graduation	Resource			Genre
Associate's degree	Travel			Inform
Bachelor's degree	Award			Convince
Master's degree	Recipient	Photography	By a long shot	Focus
Doctoral degree	Develop	Geography	Don't mess with	Topic
Specialize	Mentor (n) (v)	Architecture	Despite	Format
Semester	Challenge (n) (v)	Physics	Lead through example	Formal/informal
Program	Journey	Survey	On board	Interview
Graduate/undergraduate (n)	Public service	Design	Multi-	Website
Scholarship	Organization		Un-	Conversation
	Professional			Open-ended
	Personal			Quote
	Employee/employer			Example
	Opportunity			Visual
	Valuable			
	Goal			
	Design (n) (v)			
	Skill			
	Task			

Vocabulary Practice: College/University

Below, write the names of the four years of high school or college/university. The first year has been provided for you.

- Freshman
- ...
- ...
- ...

Below, write a list of four degrees that you can earn from a college/university. The last degree has been provided for you.

- ...
- ...
- ...
- Doctoral degree

Match the vocabulary words below to the examples.

- Vocabulary words:
 - Major

- Graduation
- Dormitory
- Specialize
- Semester
- Scholarship
- Examples:
 - A small room or apartment where students sleep
 - Spring, Summer, or Fall in college
 - Free money for students to attend school
 - Child development, biology, psychology, engineering
 - To study a specific topic deeply and in detail
 - A special celebration of the completion of a course of study

Fill in the blanks below with the following words:

- Program
- Graduate
- Undergraduate
- Declare a major

A counselor can help you _____. The counselor will ask about your interests and the classes you have already completed. Then they will help you decide what to study for your degree.

Students who are studying for an associate's degree or bachelor's degree are called _____ students. Students who are studying for a degree after their bachelor's are called _____ students.

A _____ is a plan of action to achieve a goal. You can have one for exercise, study, or other goals.

Vocabulary Practice: Careers and Education

Sometimes words in English can act as both verbs and nouns. These words have the same meaning, but they play a different role in the sentence. Below are examples.

- Example 1: Intern (v): When he was in college, he interned at an architectural company
- Example 2: Intern (n): He was an intern for three years at American Eagle Clothing company

To intern (v) means to work for a company or organization for little or no pay in exchange for education in a field or discipline

An intern (n) is a person who works for a company or organization for little or no pay in exchange for education in a field or discipline

The following words can be either nouns or verbs...

- Volunteer
- Design
- Mentor
- Challenge

Use the words above to fill in the blanks below. Check verbs to make sure you have used the correct tense and subject-verb agreement.

- When Jennifer gets her degree, she wants to _____ buildings and parks.
- The _____ for the Empire State Building is a beautiful art deco style.
- When I was a student, I _____ in the food pantry. I worked for free because I wanted to help others.
- Razia is a _____ at the symphony. She hands out programs and sells tickets, but doesn't receive any pay.
- It is a _____ to learn English. It takes a lot of time, energy, and hard work!
- Our instructor always _____ us to learn more vocabulary. After we learn 5 words, she says, "Try one more!"

- Our college has a program that matches students together to help each other. More experienced students _____ new students by showing them the campus and helping them get ready for their classes.
- When you start a new job, it's so valuable to have a _____. They will teach you about the job and help you succeed!

Some verbs in English require an object. They need to be followed by somebody (sbd) or something (sth). These verbs are transitive.

- Inspire (sbd)
- Pursue (sbd, sth)
- Develop (sth)
- Motivate (sbd)

Match the words above with their definitions or examples below...

- These two words have a very similar meaning. They both mean to cause someone to want to do something. These verbs have a very positive meaning, and always have a person as an object. The words are _____ and _____.
- This word means to follow. You can follow a person, a program, or a career. The word is _____.
- This word means to build something or cause it to grow. You can build or grow a program, a class, a problem, a relationship, an interest, an organization, or a business. The word is _____.

Fill in the blanks using the words above.

- (Two possibilities) Her eighth grade teacher _____/_____ her to study physics because he made it so interesting.
- After college, he decided to _____ a career in photography.
- In geography class, she _____ an interest in geomatics.

Here is another set of words.

- Adventure
- Travel
- Goal
- Employer
- Skills
- In high demand

Use the words above to fill in the blanks below.

What kind of career would you like? For myself, I prefer a career where my _____ is a small business, not a large organization. I want to work for a company with fewer than 20 people. I don't want a boring job. I want my job to be an _____, so I hope I will be able to do things that are exciting and even a little dangerous. I also like to _____, whether it's by plane or by car. I hope my job allows me to go to different countries. How will I get a job like this? My _____ is to earn a degree from a good university in a field that is _____. I will learn all of the _____ that I need to pursue a satisfying career.

Match the vocabulary words below with the definitions.

- **Vocabulary words:**
 - Resource
 - Recipient
 - Journey
 - Public service
 - Professional
 - Personal
 - Opportunity
 - Valuable
 - Task
- **Definitions:**

- A person who receives something
- Chance; suitable time
- A job that helps everyone in the community; sometimes a job in the government
- The act of traveling
- A small job
- A place or thing that is useful
- Private; affecting just one person
- Affecting the career or job
- Very helpful or important, or worth a lot of money

Idioms and Affixes

- **(Not) by a long shot**

- This idiom is usually used in the negative and means a strong negative
- EX: Did you pass the final exam? Not by a long shot. I wasn't prepared, so I completely failed it.
- EX: She wasn't my favorite person by a long shot. She liked to gossip and always came to my parties late and ate all the food.

- **Don't mess with (sbd, sth)**

- This is an informal idiom that means don't make this person angry or don't cause trouble with this thing
- EX: Would you like me to fix your lamp? No, please don't mess with it. Last time you fixed it, you broke it.
- EX: Don't mess with the dog next door. It might bite you.

- **Lead through example**

- This idiom means to act in a way that shows others how to act
- EX: It's important that parents lead through example. Show your kids how much you value education and they will value it too.

- **On board**

- This idiom means "on a team" or "in a group." We often use it for work, to mean "working here" or "working with us"
- EX: Now that Mike is on board at this company, our work will be much easier

- **Multi-**

- This is a prefix meaning many. Words that use "multi" include "multilingual" and "multi-task"

- **Un-/in-/im-/non-**

- These prefixes mean "not." Words that use these prefixes include "undeclared," "unfriendly," "inhospitable," "impossible," and "non-verbal"

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Writing a Profile

Learning Objectives

1. Learn about gerunds and infinitives and practice writing a paragraph with sentence variety.
2. Write and conduct a short formal interview.
3. Write a profile based on an interview.

[3.1: Grammar: Using Gerunds and Infinitives for Sentence Variety](#)

[3.2: Analyze a Profile](#)

[3.3: Classmate Profile: Writing Assignment](#)

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3.1: Grammar: Using Gerunds and Infinitives for Sentence Variety

This lesson is available as a [slide](#) presentation.

Using Gerunds and Infinitives to Improve Sentence Variety



Slide Presentation by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College



 Google Slides

Gerunds

A gerund is formed by adding -ing to the base form of the verb

- EX: Talking
- EX: Reading
- EX: Saying

A gerund is NOT a verb

Study these two sentences. Is "hiking" the verb in each sentence?

- Hiking is one of his favorite activities.
- They are hiking in the mountains today.

How do you know?

Answers

In the first sentence, "hiking" is a gerund. It is not preceded by "be" and it acts like the subject of the sentence. The verb is "is." In the second sentence, "hiking" is a verb. It is preceded by "be" (am) and follows the subject

A gerund acts like a noun in the sentence. Like a noun, a gerund can be the subject or subject complement of a sentence, the object of a verb, or the object of a preposition...

- Gerund + verb + object
- Subject + verb + gerund
- Subject + verb + preposition + gerund
- Preposition + gerund + subject + verb

Study these sentences. Which one has a gerund as the subject of the verb? Which one has a gerund as the object of the verb? Which has a gerund as the object of a preposition?

- Mentoring other employees is his favorite part of the job.
- Her decision to major in medicine was based on volunteering at the hospital.
- They love inspiring other students at the college.

Answers

- In the first sentence, "mentoring" is the subject of the verb "is"
- In the second sentence, "volunteering" is the object of the preposition "on"
- In the third sentence, "inspiring" is the object of the verb "love"

Infinitives

An infinitive is formed with "to" and the base form of the verb

- EX: To talk
- EX: To read
- EX: To say

An infinitive is not a verb. It acts like a noun in a sentence. An infinitive usually follows certain verbs in a sentence in this verb:

- Subject + verb + infinitive

Or a linking verb and an adjective in this pattern:

- "It linking verb + adjective + infinitive

Study the sentences below. What are the verbs? What are the infinitives?

- After he finishes college, he wants to work as a geologist.
- It's important to listen during an interview.

Answers

- In the first sentence, the verb is "wants" and the infinitive is "to work"
- In the second sentence, the verb is "is" and the infinitive is "to listen"

Verbs with Gerunds and Infinitives

Some verbs may be followed by gerunds, some may be followed by infinitives, and some may be followed by both...

- EX: I like reading
- EX: I like to read
- BAD EX: I promise studying
- EX: I promise to study
- EX: She enjoys eating chocolate
- BAD EX: She enjoys to eat chocolate

Below is a short list of verbs with gerunds and infinitives...

Verbs/phrases followed by a gerund	Verbs followed by an infinitive	Verbs/phrases followed by either with little change in meaning	Verbs followed by either with a different meaning
Dislike Appreciate Enjoy (not) Face Look forward to Consider Imagine Recall Miss Recommend Admit (to) Deny Describe Mention Prohibit Report Suggest Postpone Delay Put off Risk Avoid Mean Practice Go	Would like Expect Hope Need Agree Appear/seem Ask Get (be allowed) Offer Refuse Plan Wait Promise Intend Tend Afford	Like Love Cannot bear, cannot stand Prefer Hate Continue Begin/start	Remember Forget Try Stop Regret

More complete lists may be found [here](#) and [here](#)...

Forget, Remember, Try, Regret, Stop

These verbs change meaning when used with a gerund or infinitive. Watch [this video](#) and [this video](#) for more information...

Using gerunds and infinitives enhances your writing by:

- Adding sentence variety
- Helping you develop your ideas
- Making your writing more formal and academic

Compare the following paragraphs. Which paragraph is better? Why?

Paragraph 1

If you want to be happy, you should do five things. Be grateful. You should always be grateful for what you have. Count your blessings. You should make a list of good things. Be optimistic. You should think positive thoughts. Use your strengths. You should do things that you are good at. Commit acts of kindness. You should do kind actions.

Paragraph 2

In order to boost happiness, there are five methods people can use. First, being grateful can improve our sense of well-being. We can write a letter or email to someone who helped us, just to say "Thank you." Some people also express gratitude by praying or meditating. Second, it's important to notice the good things in life. Writing down a list of things we appreciate is a good way to

count our blessings every day. Third, it helps to be optimistic. We should always try to keep a positive attitude and expect the best outcomes. Another method to boost happiness is by using our strengths. People feel happier when they are using their natural abilities. Finally, committing acts of kindness is one of the most important methods of increasing happiness. When we do something helpful for another person, we feel more satisfied with life.

Questions About the Paragraphs Above

- What verb forms does the first paragraph use? What person (you, he/she/it, we/they) does each paragraph use?
- Which paragraph is more formal and sophisticated? Why?
- The second paragraph is more developed. What did the author do to develop the ideas more completely?
- Identify the gerunds and infinitives in the second paragraph

Answers

- The first paragraph uses second person (you) It uses one modal, "should," and the imperative voice. The second paragraph uses first person plural (we) and third person plural (they). It uses gerunds, infinitives, and a variety of modals
- The second paragraph is more formal because it uses first person plural and third person, and it is more sophisticated because it has more sentence variety
- The author gave specific examples
- The gerunds and infinitives in the second paragraph are as follows:
 - To boost
 - Being
 - To say
 - Praying
 - Meditating
 - To notice
 - Writing
 - To count
 - To be
 - To keep
 - To boost
 - Using
 - Committing
 - Increasing

Videos and Other Resources

Watch [this video](#) for more information about gerunds and infinitives...

In [this video](#), learn more about gerunds and infinitives as objects of verbs...

Try [this website](#) for a complete explanation of gerunds and infinitives with exercises and feedback...

Practice with Gerunds and Infinitives

Ask a friend or family the questions below. Then write a short paragraph (at least six sentences) with gerunds and infinitives about your friend/family member. Use the chart in this chapter to decide if you should use a gerund or infinitive with each verb or phrase...

- What do you like to do in your free time?
- Describe your favorite memory from your childhood. What do you remember doing?
- What activity have you tried and failed to do?
- What movies or TV shows do you recommend seeing?
- What do you hope to do next year? In five years?
- What do you dislike most about your everyday routine? Why?
- What are you looking forward to doing tomorrow?

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3.2: Analyze a Profile

Analyze a Profile

In this chapter, you have had the opportunity to read and watch several profiles. On this page, we will summarize the types of profiles and analyze the rhetorical features of a profile.

In the spaces below, decide if the profile you read was an employee/intern profile, a student profile, or a profile of a famous person. Consider the institution that published each profile to help you decide.

Leslie Reynolds _____

Cody Gibson _____

Jennifer Moy _____

Felipe Valdez _____

Brandon Stanton _____

Diana Nyad _____

In the spaces below, write the focus of each profile. Choose from these four:

Career accomplishments and goals

Educational accomplishments and goals

Artistic process

Passion (a strong interest)

Leslie Reynolds _____

Cody Gibson _____

Jennifer Moy _____

Felipe Valdez _____

Brandon Stanton _____

Diana Nyad _____

Each of the profiles highlights the values of the subject. Match the values that you believe are most important to each subject.

Diana Nyad	learning about people
Felipe Valdez	adventures and travel
Brandon Stanton	designing buildings
Cody Gibson	strength and persistence
Jennifer Moy	research in mechanical engineering

Which of the profiles you read or watched was the most interesting to you? Why?

Review these questions from section 1.1. Can you answer them with more confidence now?

- A profile is:
 - About one person
 - About many people
- A profile is:
 - Short
 - Long
- A profile has:

- A profile has:
 - A person's whole life history
 - A few facts about the person's history
- A profile focuses on:
 - One part of a person's life, such as work, school, a hobby, or a special interest
 - Everything that is important to that person
- A profile has:
 - A negative tone
 - A positive tone
- A profile is about:
 - Someone famous
 - Anyone

Analyze the features of a profile

Examine the reading about Leslie Reynolds again and notice the parts (features) of the profile that are common.

Leslie Reynolds Profile

The first sentence with the reason for the profile

- Congratulations to the 2015 recipient of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger Award!

Photo and caption



- Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

The "big picture" and focus of the profile (career, studies, art, hobby, etc.)

- After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible journey of public service and adventures in parks across the country.

History and achievements related to the focus of the profile (her career)

- Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.

- Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped develop the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

Current and future predictions or wishes for success

- As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to inspire the new generation of park rangers and lead through example.

Quote from the interviewee related to the focus of the profile...

- "I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is rewarding, that I am proud of, and one that continues to challenge me every day," said Reynolds. "My inspiration comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most rewarding aspects of my profession is developing and mentoring others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Now examine the profile about Jennifer Moy. Can you find some or all of the same features of a profile? Which features are missing?

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.



Figure 3.2.1: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

[Rhetorical analysis answer key](#)

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3.3: Classmate Profile: Writing Assignment

Writing Assignment

For this assignment, you will interview a classmate and write a profile about that classmate.

For the interview and profile, you will need:

- Paper for notes and a pen or pencil
- A phone or other recording device
- An English dictionary
- A list of questions

Initial Interview

Your instructor will pair you with a classmate. Ask your classmate the following questions. Take notes.

1. What is your full name?
2. Where and when were you born?
3. What is your current living situation (who do you live with and where)?
4. What do you think are the two most important events that happened in your life?
5. Tell me about two activities that interest you most.

Writing Interview Questions

On your own paper, write 15 questions that you can ask your classmate. Under each question, leave space for notes.

Use the answers to number 4 and 5 above to focus your questions. In other words, if your partner tells you they are interested in sports, write several questions about sports such as 'What type of sports do you like?' and 'Why do you like....?'

Write open-ended questions. Open-ended questions invite a longer and more detailed answer, and often start with 'how,' or 'why.'

Second Interview

Interview your classmate. Follow the suggestions below.

- Interview your classmate and take notes on their answers to the questions.
- Consider using a recording device.
- Follow [Celeste Headlee's](#) advice and be a good listener.
- To start the interview, ask your classmate the standard background information to get the name, place he or she was born, age, etc.
- Ask your 15 questions
- Use open-ended questions and follow up questions; try to get more detail. For example, if you ask, "Do you like your job?" and he answers "yes," follow up with, "Why do you like it?" If he responds, "Because it gives me a lot of free time," follow up with, "What do you like to do in your free time and why do you enjoy it?"
- You can ask for more information after the interview. Ask your classmate for their contact information so you can email, call or text them with any questions you think of later.

Writing the Profile

Write a profile about your classmate. Use the information you learned from reading and watching profiles in the Chapter [Exploring Profiles](#) and analyzing profiles in [What is a Profile](#).

- Use your notes to write the profile. Be sure that the profile:
 - Is one to two pages with double-spaced lines
 - Keeps your audience, genre, and purpose in mind as you write the profile
 - Audience: Your classmates

- Genre: Profile
- Purpose: To convince other students about the interesting lives of students in the class

Grading Criteria

Follow the bullet points in the grading rubric below about how to write a profile. A grid rubric is attached.

- Content (30 points) Your profile should...
 - Have a focus on one positive aspect of your classmate (his or her education goal, a past or present important life experience, an important value(s), etc.)
 - Include at least two of the following: The history of this person's achievements, a description of the person or what their life was in the past or what is happening in the present, a photo, or a quotation from the person
 - Be one to two pages double-spaced
 - Be based on the interview questions and answers
 - Reveal a rich and interesting conversation with the person you interviewed
- Organization/Format (15 points) Your profile should...
 - Start with a sentence that shows the focus of the profile
 - Include the person's first name in the first or second sentence
 - Use at least two signal words for cohesion and coherence
 - Look like a profile (see the examples in Chapter 1 and 2)
- Vocabulary/Style/Tone (20 points) Your profile should...
 - Have a formal, positive and friendly tone
 - Use the third person voice (the person's name and he/she/"my classmate")
 - Be written in your own words. Do not copy from any other source
 - Use sufficient vocabulary to describe your classmate and the focus in detail
- Grammar and Sentence Structure (25 points) Your profile should...
 - Use the verb tenses needed to talk about your classmate and his/her life events (present simple and continuous, past simple and continuous, and future)
 - Include a variety of sentence types
 - Be carefully edited for accuracy
- Mechanics (5 points) Your profile should...
 - Use correct capitalization, punctuation (periods, commas, etc.) and spelling
- Notes/Mind Map (5 points)
 - Have sufficient and accurate notes taken before writing to complete the writing task

Profile Grading Rubric, Grid format

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: For the Instructor

[4.2: Analyze a Profile Key](#)

[4.3: Past Tense Practice: Dictogloss Activity](#)

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4.2: Analyze a Profile Key

Analyze a Profile

What is a profile? Examine the reading about Leslie Reynolds again and notice the parts (features) of the profile that are common...

Leslie Reynolds Profile

The first sentence with the reason for the profile...

- Congratulations to the 2015 recipient of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger Award!

Photo and caption...



- Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

The "big picture" and focus of the profile (career, studies, art, hobby, etc.)...

- After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible journey of public service and adventures in parks across the country.

History and achievements related to the focus of the profile (her career)...

- Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.
- Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped develop the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

Current and future predictions or wishes for success...

- As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to inspire the new generation of park rangers and lead through example.

Quote from the interviewee related to the focus of the profile...

- "I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is rewarding, that I am proud of, and one that continues to challenge me every day," said Reynolds. "My inspiration comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most rewarding aspects of my profession is developing and mentoring others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Now examine the profile about Jennifer Moy. Can you find some or all of the same features of a profile? Take notes on each part of the profile. Which features are missing?

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.



Figure 4.2.1: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

Answers

This section suggests the focus of the profile will be Jennifer's choice of major...

- Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

These parts show Jennifer's history and how she is connected to the library. The focus is on her choices related to education (major, college)...

- Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan.
- When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.
- Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

A quote from the interviewee is very common at the end of a profile...

- "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday."

Current and future predictions /wishes for success...

- Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering:
- We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

Photo and caption...



• Jennifer Moy

Discussion Points for the Instructor

The second profile has many of the same features as Reynold's profile, including the photo, quote, current and future good wishes, and history.

The student spotlight does not have the opening 'hook' that is often present in profiles and is missing an introductory sentence that tells the reader why this person is being profiled. Which version do students prefer?

The subject of the profile is different from Reynold's profile, and since Jennifer Moy is a student and has fewer accomplishments so far, the focus is on her choices in education, which other students at Stony Brook might relate to. Her connection to the library is not emphasized as strongly as Reynold's connection to the National Park Service, because she is not receiving an award for twenty years of service. The audience also differs. Perhaps the student spotlight appeals to other students, inviting them to work at the library or visit the library. The Reynold's profile might be a motivational text for career employees at the NPS or a promotional text to showcase the strength of the staff at NPS to funding agencies.

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4.3: Past Tense Practice: Dictogloss Activity

For the Instructor

Choose a short reading below. Read and discuss the pre-reading questions with the class. Then read the text slowly. Address student questions about unfamiliar vocabulary. Read the text at least three times. Ask students to take notes on the second or third time through.

Students write a summary of the text, using the correct verb tense. You may have students write individual summaries, then share with a partner, or work in pairs or groups to write a summary. Ask pairs or groups to share their product. Classmates can listen and make corrections, especially in verb tense.

Short Reading 1

Read three times; students take notes then summarize...

Pre-reading Questions

- Do women have the right to vote in the U.S.? In your country? When did women win this right?
- Do you think there should be more women in politics? Why or why not?

Text

Jeannette Rankin was born on June 11, 1880. Her parents were John and Olive Rankin. She grew up in Montana and graduated from the University of Montana in 1902. After she graduated, she worked for women's right to vote in Washington State and Montana. She stayed in the congress for one term. She ran for congress again in 1940 and won. She was a pacifist. This means she was against war and believed the U.S. should not participate in any war. She voted against the U.S. joining World War 1 in 1917 and World War 2 in 1941. She was the only congressperson who voted against joining World War 2.

Short Reading 2

Read three times; students take notes then summarize...

Pre-reading Questions

- What do you know about climate change?
- Who are some famous climate change activists?
- What do climate change activists do?

Text

Greta Thunberg is a leader in the movement against climate change. She was born on January 3, 2002 in Sweden. In 2018, she began spending her school days outside the Swedish parliament. She held a sign that said "School strike for climate." She wanted them to take stronger action to stop climate change. At first, she was alone, but soon, other students joined her protests. Together, they organized a school climate strike called Fridays for the Future.

Thunberg addressed the United Nations Climate Change Conference in 2018. Students began striking every week around the world. In 2019, millions of students protested around the world, asking for stronger action to stop the climate crisis.

In May 2019, *Time* magazine showed Thunberg on their cover. They called her the person of the year. In September 2019, she addressed the UN Climate Action Summit in New York. She was also nominated for the Nobel Peace Prize in 2019.

Short Reading 3

Read three times; students take notes then summarize...

Pre-reading Questions

- Have you ever swum in the ocean?
- What are some dangers of swimming in the ocean?
- What is the farthest a human can swim?

Alternative Pre-reading

Diana Nyad's TED talk is available [here](#)...

Text

Diana Nyad is the first person to swim from Havana, Cuba to Florida without a shark cage. She swam 110 miles (180 kilometers) and fifty-three hours. She was 64 years old when she accomplished her goal.

How did she do it?

Nyad attempted the swim five times from 2010 to 2013 and did not succeed until her fifth try in 2013. Each time she tried, she had to stop because of storms, jellyfish stings, asthma, and shoulder pain. On Sept. 2, 2013, she reached her goal despite these setbacks.

She trained by swimming eight to fourteen hours in the ocean every other week. While she was training, she gathered a team of about 35 people. These people helped her while she was swimming. One person paddled beside her in a kayak and used a device to keep sharks away from her. Others helped her put on a suit to keep jellyfish from stinging her. In order to help her swim in a straight line, her team dragged a streamer during the day and LED lights at night behind a boat and she followed them. To keep her mind busy while she was swimming, she thought about books and movies, counted, and sang.

When asked about her motivation, she answered, "Because I'd like to prove to the other 60-year-olds that it is never too late to start your dreams."

 File:Diana Nyad routes.jpg - Wikimedia Commons

Figure 4.3.1: Nyad's Havana to Key West swimming routes since 1978

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